

Designing a verifiable penalty

**1. Penalize a verifiable ACTION,
not lack of progress**

penalizing omission rewards doing nothing

**2. Keep the outcome reward as the driver;
never optimize a penalty alone**

a lone penalty stalls: the inaction trap

**3. Pair the penalty with a DISCHARGE
(reward the compliant action)**

pull toward doing it right, not just away

**4. Make the compliant path reachable
and its target un-gameable**

seed a demo; avoid a learned proxy

a penalty that bounds the path without stalling the task